

UNIT 6

INTRODUCTION TO ADOBE PHOTOSHOP



Learning Objectives

1. Launch Photoshop and identify key workspace components.
2. Create a new file with custom dimensions and appropriate presets.
3. Perform layer operations and manage visibility, locking, and order.
4. Locate the Tool Palette and use basic tools like Move, Brush, and Text.
5. Apply selection, drawing, and text tools to complete basic tasks.
6. Use Marquee tools to create rectangular, elliptical, row, or column selections.
7. Use Lasso tools to create straight-edged or edge-snapping selections.
8. Save files in PSD or export them in formats like JPEG and PNG.
9. Open existing files in Photoshop and identify supported formats.

What is Photoshop?

Photoshop is a powerful raster-based software used for image editing, graphic design, and digital art. It allows designers to create and manipulate visuals at a pixel level, making it an industry standard for various creative fields.

- **Photo Editing:**

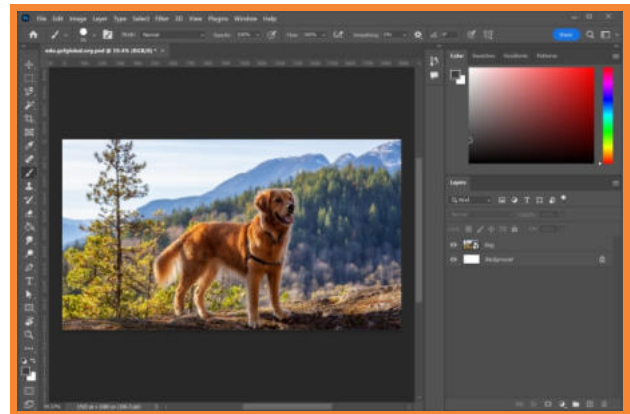
Retouching and restoring photos.

- **Design:**

Creating flyers, social media posts, and websites.

- **Digital Art:**

Making illustrations and photo manipulations.



- **Key Concept:** Photoshop uses pixels, making it suitable for print and digital designs. Always set high resolution (300 DPI) for print to avoid pixelation.

Navigating the Photoshop Interface

- **Menu Bar:** Access file operations and editing functions.
- **Toolbar:** Provides essential tools like Move, Selection, and Brush.
- **Workspace:** Displays the canvas and panels.
- **Layers Panel:** Manages layers, enabling non-destructive editing.
- **Customizing the Workspace:**
 - Enable/disable panels via the Window menu.
 - Reset the workspace to default using Window > Workspace > Reset Essentials.

Starting Photoshop

•Steps to Launch Photoshop 2020:

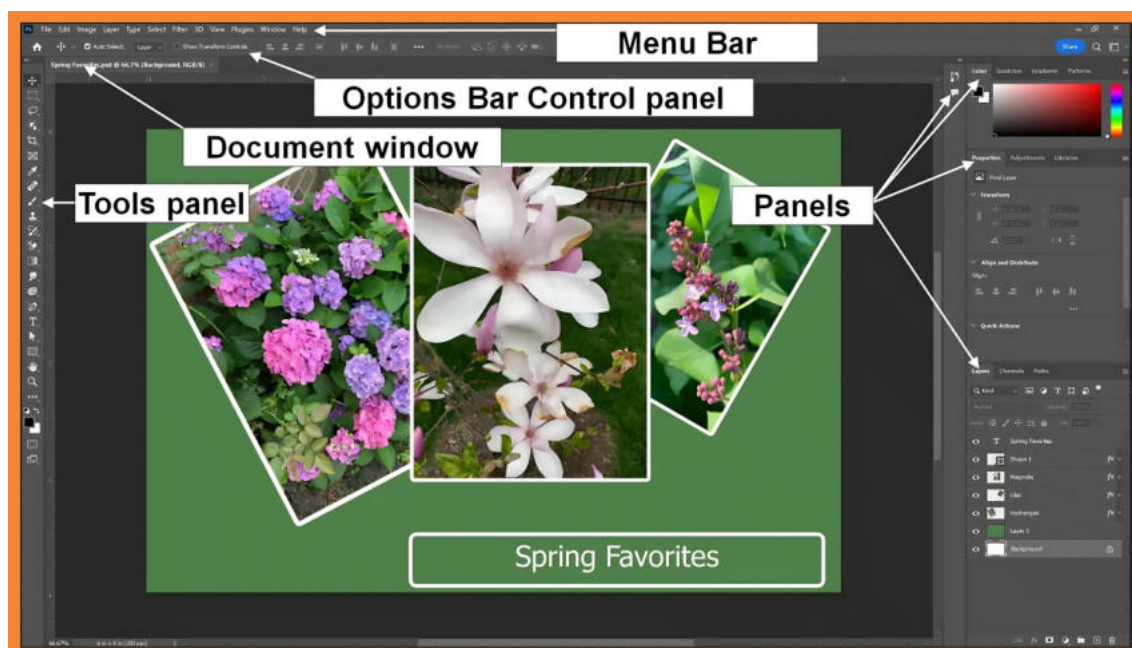
1. Double-click the Photoshop icon on your desktop or locate it in your Start menu.
2. Wait for the program to load and display the workspace.

• Overview of the Welcome Screen:

- Recent projects: A quick access panel for previously edited files.
- New file options: Create a project with preset templates.
- Tutorials: Access learning resources directly from Adobe.

• Exploring Workspace Layout:

- **Toolbar:** Located on the left, containing tools for selection, drawing, and editing.
- **Options Bar:** At the top, showing settings for the selected tool.
- **Panels:** Found on the right, includes Layers, Properties, and more.
- **Canvas:** The main area where designs and edits take place.



Adobe Photoshop is a powerful graphic design and photo editing software used for creating, enhancing, and manipulating images and designs. A key feature of Photoshop that makes it versatile is its **Document Presets**, which simplify the process of starting new projects by providing predefined templates suited for various purposes.

What are Document Presets?

Document presets are pre-configured settings in Photoshop designed to streamline your workflow by automatically adjusting the canvas size, resolution, colour mode, and other essential parameters based on the type of project you're working on.

Types of Document Presets

1. Social Media Posts

- Presets for popular social media platforms like Instagram, Facebook, or Twitter.
- Example sizes:
 - Instagram Post: 1080x1080 pixels.
 - Facebook Cover: 820x312 pixels.
- Configurations often include optimized resolutions and colour modes (like RGB) for on-screen viewing.

2. A4 Documents

- Preset for standard paper size (210mm x 297mm).
- Typically used for printable projects like flyers, brochures, or reports.
- Often set with a resolution of 300 DPI (Dots Per Inch) and CMYK colour mode for print quality.

3. Web Banners

- Presets for website or digital ads.
- Example sizes:
 - Leaderboard: 728x90 pixels.
 - Medium Rectangle: 300x250 pixels.
- These presets are optimized for web use with smaller file sizes and RGB colour mode.

Why Should We Use Document Presets?

- **Efficiency:** Quickly set up a project without manually configuring dimensions and settings.
- **Consistency:** Maintain uniform sizes and formats across similar projects.
- **Ease of Use:** Suitable for beginners and professionals to ensure correct settings for print, web, or screen-based projects.

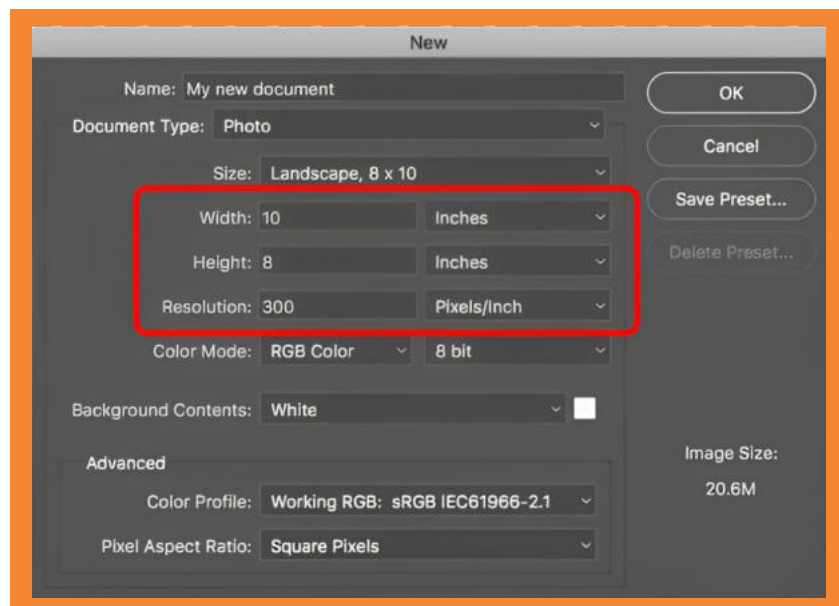
How to Access Document Presets

1. **Open Photoshop** and go to **File > New**.
2. In the **New Document** dialog box:
 - Browse through tabs like **Photo, Print, Web, Mobile, or Film & Video**.
 - Select a preset that matches your project's requirements.
3. Customize further if needed (e.g., changing resolution or orientation).
4. Click **Create** to start your project.

How to Create a New File

• Steps to Create a New File:

1. Navigate to File > New or press Ctrl + N.
2. Choose a preset or define custom dimensions.
3. Set the resolution and colour mode (e.g., RGB for digital or CMYK for print).
4. Click "Create" to open a blank canvas.



Using Layers

What Are Layers?

- Layers are like transparent sheets stacked on top of each other. Each layer can hold elements such as images, text, or effects, which can be edited without affecting other layers.

• Advantages of Layers:

- **Non-destructive editing:** Each design element is isolated.
- **Flexibility:** Easily rearrange, hide, or modify individual components.

Basic Layer Operations:

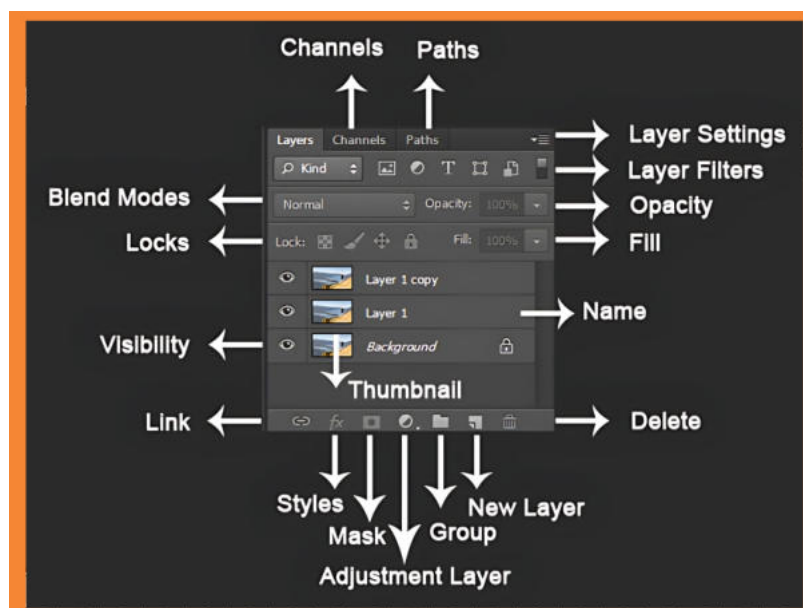
1. Add a New Layer: Press Shift + Ctrl + N or click the "New Layer" icon in the Layers Palette.

2. Delete a Layer: Select the layer and press Delete or drag it to the trash icon.

3. Duplicate a Layer: Right-click the layer and select "Duplicate Layer" or press Ctrl + J.

Hands-on Activity:

1. Open a new file in Photoshop and add three layers: one for text, one for shapes, and one for a background.
2. Practise deleting and duplicating layers to observe their effects.



Using Layers Palette

Functions of the Layers Palette:**1. Visibility Toggle:**

- Click the eye icon next to a layer to hide or show it.
- Use this to compare design variations or focus on specific layers.

2. Lock Options:

- **Lock Transparency:** Prevents changes to transparent areas of a layer.
- **Lock Position:** Prevents accidental movement of a layer.
- **Fully Lock:** Prevents any changes to the layer.

3. Group Layers:

- Select multiple layers, right-click, and choose "**Group**" to organize them.
- Useful for complex projects with many elements.

Lab Activity:

1. Create a simple project with five layers: text, two images, and two shapes.
2. Lock one shape layer and try to move it to see the lock in action.
3. Group all layers except the text and rename the group.

Rearranging Layers

Reordering Layers:

- Drag layers up or down in the Layers Palette to change their stacking order.
- Example: Move a text layer above an image layer to make the text visible.

Merging Layers:

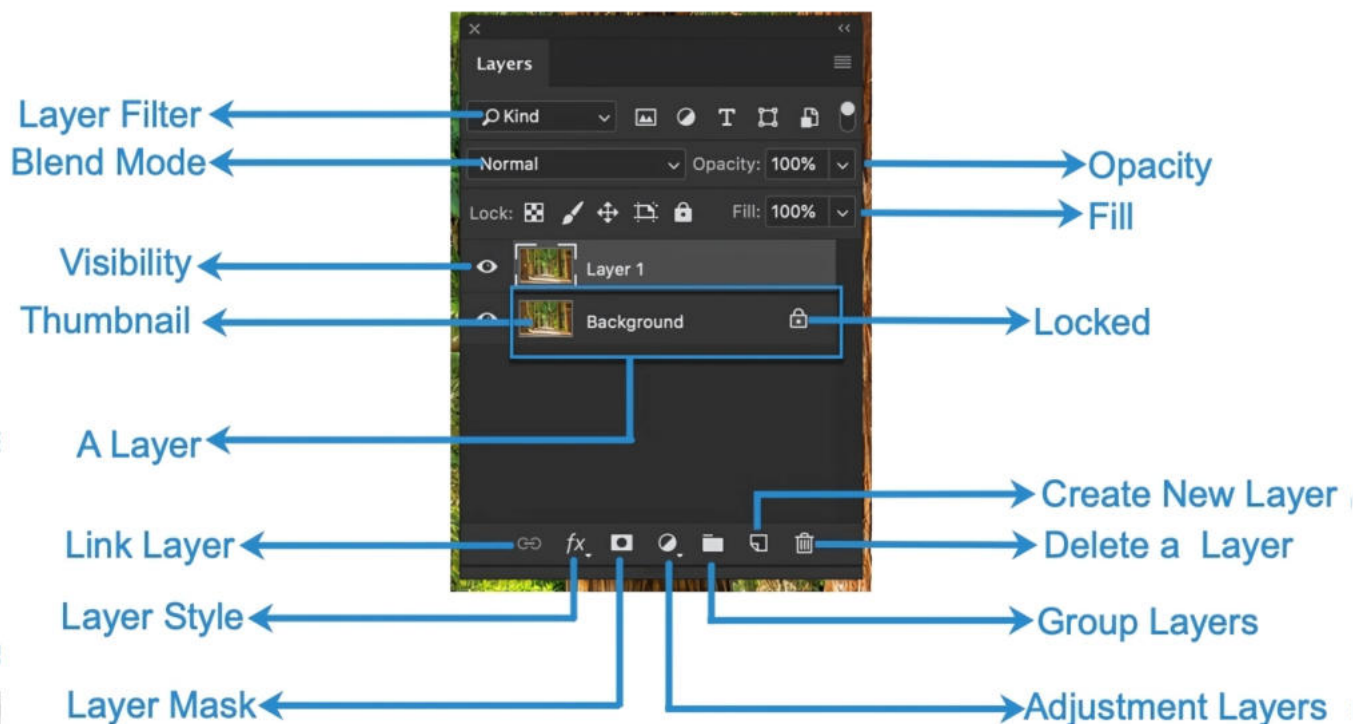
- Combine multiple layers into one to simplify editing or reduce file size.
- **How to Merge:**
 - Select layers, right-click, and choose "**Merge Layers**" or press

Ctrl + E.**Practical Example:**

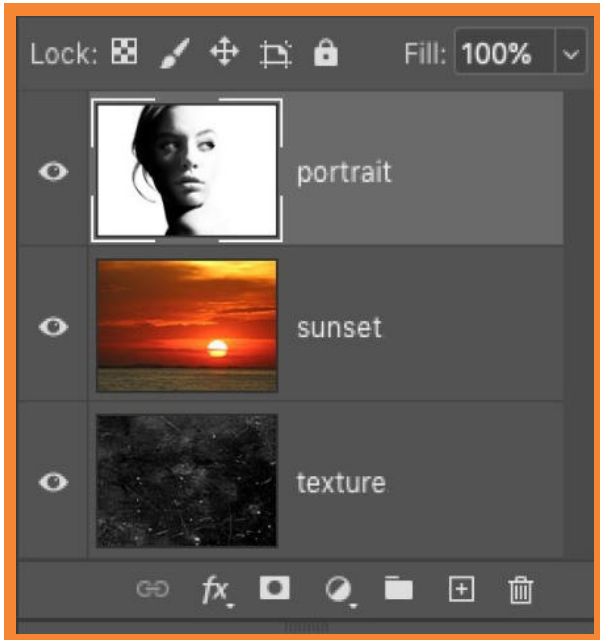
1. Create a logo with separate layers for text, shapes, and a background.
2. Rearrange the layers to position the text above the shapes.
3. Merge the shape layers after finalizing their arrangement.

Lab Activity :

1. Design a three-layer project: a background colour, a geometric shape, and text.
2. Rearrange the layers to see how stacking order affects the design.
3. Merge the geometric shape and text layers into one.



Layers sequence
(Unmerged)



Final result after Ctrl+E
(Merged)



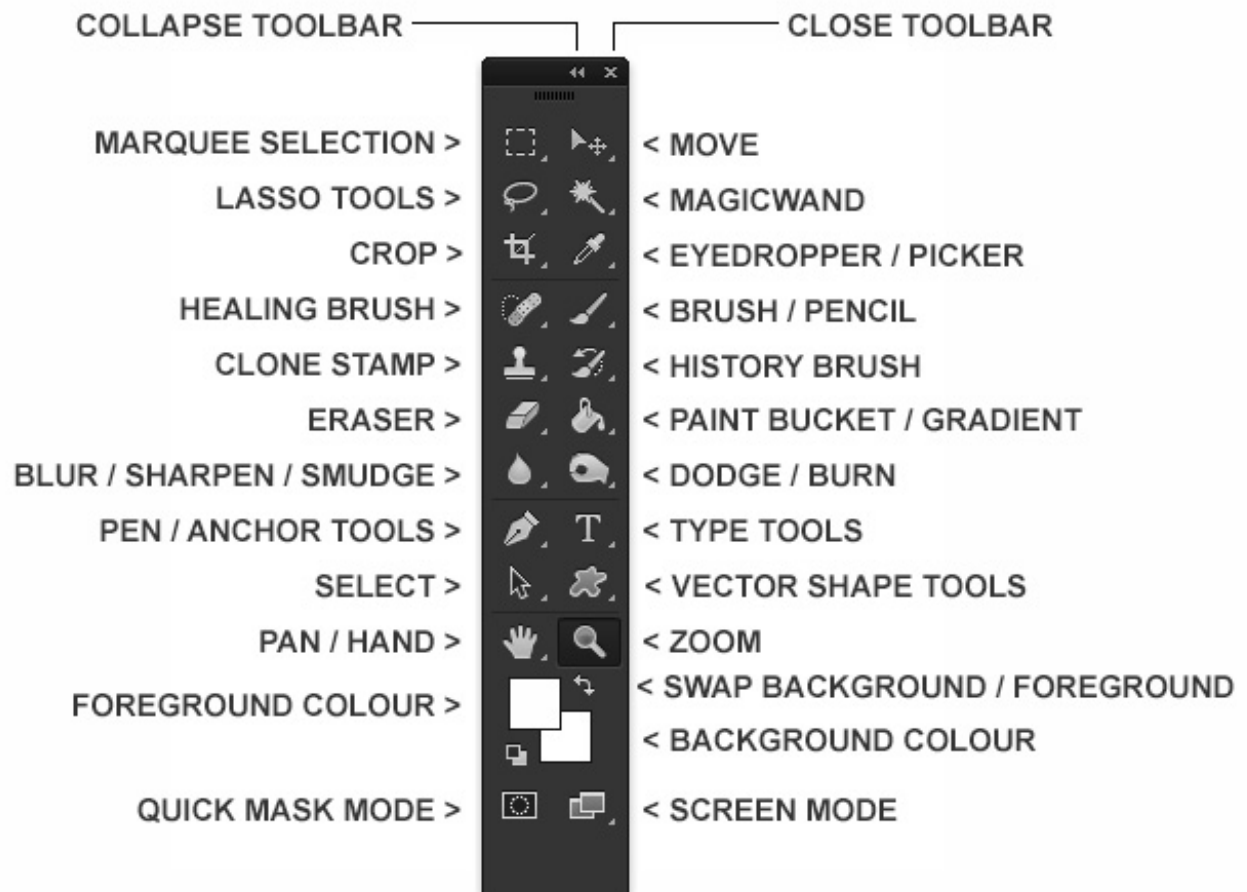
How to Use Photoshop Tools

Tool Palette

- **Introduction to the Tool Palette:**
- The tool palette is a vertical toolbar on the left side of the interface, offering a variety of tools for editing and designing.

Description of Commonly Used Tools

- **Move Tool:** Moves selected objects or layers.
- **Brush Tool:** Allows painting with various brush styles.
- **Eraser Tool:** Removes parts of an image or design.
- **Text Tool:** Adds and edits text layers.



Tool Palette

Selection Tools

1. Marquee Tool:

- The Marquee Tool is used for creating geometric selections, such as rectangles, squares, ellipses, or circles.

- **How to Use:**

1. Select the Rectangular or Elliptical Marquee Tool from the toolbar.
2. Click and drag on the canvas to define the selection area.
3. Hold Shift while dragging to create a perfect square or circle.

- **Practical Application:** Use the Marquee Tool to isolate part of an image for cropping or applying effects.

Lab Activity: Select an area of a photo using the Rectangular Marquee Tool and add a solid colour fill to the selection.

2. Lasso Tools:

- **Polygonal Lasso Tool:** Best for straight-edged selections. Click to set points, and double-click to close the selection.
- **Magnetic Lasso Tool:** Automatically snaps to the edges of objects while dragging.
- **Freehand Lasso Tool:** Allows freeform selections by clicking and dragging.

Lab Activity: Use the Polygonal Lasso Tool to cut out a specific object from an image and place it on a new layer.

3. Quick Selection Tool:

- Quickly selects areas based on colour and texture similarity.

How to Use:

1. Select the Quick Selection Tool from the toolbar.
2. Click and drag over the area you want to select. The tool will automatically expand the selection.
3. Adjust the brush size for finer control using the Options Bar.

Lab Activity:

Open an image of a person, use the Quick Selection Tool to select the background, and remove it using the "Delete" key.

Drawing Tools

1. Brush Tool:

- The Brush Tool is used for painting and creating artistic effects.

Customization Options:

- Change brush size and hardness using the Options Bar.
- Select the Brush Preset Picker to choose different styles.
- Adjust opacity and flow for varied effects.
- **Practical Example:** Create a gradient effect by selecting two colours and painting with a soft round brush.

Lab Activity:

Use the Brush Tool to create an abstract background by blending colours with varying brush sizes and opacities.

2. Pencil Tool:

- Creates hard-edged lines and shapes for pixel-perfect designs.

Lab Activity:

Draw a pixel art object, such as a simple house or tree, using the Pencil Tool.

3. Shape Tools:

- **Types:** Rectangle, Ellipse, Polygon, Line, and Custom Shapes.
- **How to Use:**
 1. Select a Shape Tool from the toolbar.
 2. Click and drag on the canvas to draw the shape.
 3. Customize fill colour, stroke, and dimensions using the Options Bar.

Lab Activity:

Design a logo by combining shapes and adjusting their colours and styles.

4. Text Tool

- **Adding Text:**
 1. Select the Horizontal or Vertical Type Tool from the toolbar.
 2. Click on the canvas to create a text layer.
 3. Type your text and customize the font, size, colour, and alignment using the Options Bar.
- **Customization Options:**
 - Apply layer styles like shadows or gradients to the text.
 - Use the Character Panel for advanced options like kerning and tracking.

Lab Activity:

Create a social media post with text overlay.
Experiment with fonts, colours, and layer styles.

Practical Example

Using the Brush Tool to Create a Gradient Effect:

1. Create a new file with a white background.
2. Select the Brush Tool and choose a soft round brush.
3. Set the foreground colour to a vibrant hue (e.g., blue) and the background colour to another (e.g., orange).
4. Paint strokes across the canvas, blending colours smoothly by lowering opacity.
5. Save the file as a JPEG to use as a background.

Lab Activity:

Recreate the example and experiment with different brush styles and colour combinations to create unique gradients.

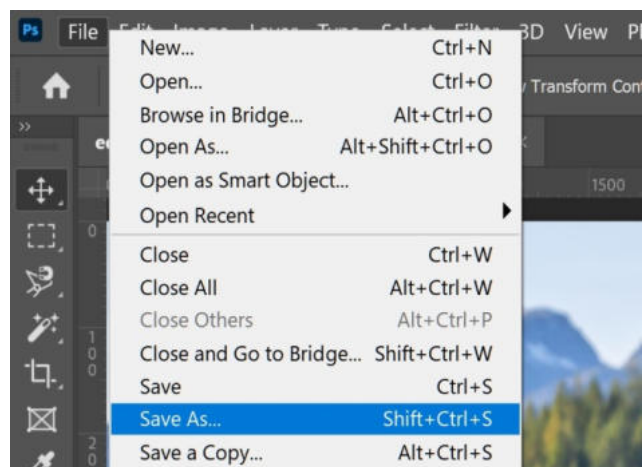
How to Save a File

• Steps to Save a File:

1. Go to File > Save or press Ctrl + S.
2. Select a file format (e.g., PSD for ongoing work or JPEG for sharing).
3. Name the file and click "Save."

• Difference Between "Save" and "Save As":

- "Save": Updates the existing file.
- "Save As": Creates a new copy with a different name or format.

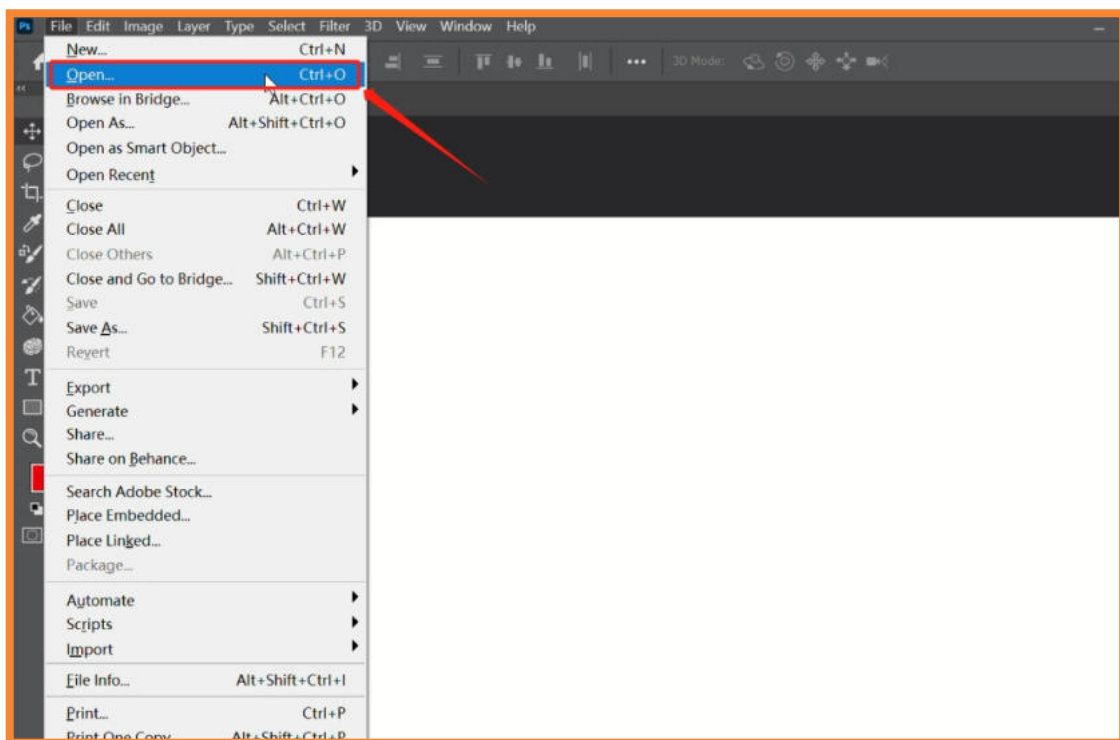


How to Open an Existing File

• Steps to Open Files:

1. Click File > Open or press Ctrl + O.
2. Browse to the file location and select it.
3. Click "Open" to load the file into the workspace.

• **Supported File Types:** Photoshop supports PSD, JPEG, PNG, TIFF, and more.



EXERCISES

01: Choose the correct answer.

1.What is Photoshop primarily used for?

- a) Word processing
- b) Image editing and design
- c) Video editing
- d) Spreadsheet management

2.Which file format should you use to preserve layers in Photoshop?

- a) JPEG
- b) PNG
- c) PSD
- d) TIFF

3.What does the Marquee Tool do?

- a) Moves objects
- b) Creates geometric selections
- c) Paints using a brush
- d) Deletes layers

4.Which tool is best for making freeform selections?

- a) Lasso Tool
 - b) Marquee Tool
 - c) Quick Selection Tool
 - d) Move Tool
-

5.What is the shortcut to create a new file in Photoshop?

- a) Ctrl + N
- b) Ctrl + S
- c) Ctrl + O
- d) Ctrl + J

6.What resolution is recommended for print projects to avoid pixelation?

- a) 72 DPI
- b) 150 DPI
- c) 300 DPI
- d) 600 DPI

7.What is the primary purpose of the Layers Panel?

- a) To manage layer visibility and stacking order
- b) To edit text
- c) To adjust colours
- d) To save files

8.Which tool is used to paint on the canvas in Photoshop?

- a) Text Tool
- b) Brush Tool
- c) Move Tool
- d) Eraser Tool

9. Which menu allows you to reset the workspace layout?

- a) Edit
- b) Window
- c) View
- d) File

10. What does the "Save As" option in Photoshop allow you to do?

- a) Update the existing file
 - b) Create a new copy of the file with a different name or format
 - c) Flatten the layers
 - d) Export only as JPEG
-

02: Fill in the blanks.

1. Photoshop is a _____ software used for image editing, graphic design, and digital art.
2. The _____ Tool is used to create rectangular or elliptical selections.
3. To reset the workspace to its default layout, use the _____ menu.
4. _____ layers allow for non-destructive editing in Photoshop.
5. The shortcut to duplicate a layer is _____.
6. The _____ Tool is used to move objects or layers in the canvas.

03: Select True or False for each statement.

	TRUE	FALSE
The Text Tool is used to create and edit text layers.	☐	☐
Photoshop is vector-based software.	☐	☐
The Brush Tool can only be used with hard edges.	☐	☐
The Layers Panel allows for rearranging, locking, and merging layers.	☐	☐
A resolution of 300 DPI is suitable for print projects.	☐	☐
The Quick Selection Tool is used for precise, straight-edged selections.	☐	☐

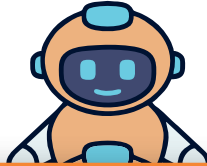
04: Answer the following questions briefly.

1. What is the primary difference between "Save" and "Save As" in Photoshop?
2. Explain the purpose of the Layers Panel in Photoshop.
3. How can you reset the Photoshop workspace to its default layout?
4. Name three tools found in the Tool Palette and describe their uses.
5. What is the importance of setting the resolution to 300 DPI for print projects?
6. How do you create a new file in Photoshop with custom dimensions?

05: Provide detailed answer for the following questions.

1. Describe the steps to create a new file in Photoshop and explain how to save it as PSD and export it as JPEG.
2. Explain the concept of layers in Photoshop and their advantages for design projects.
3. Discuss three selection tools in Photoshop and provide examples of their practical applications.
4. Write a step-by-step guide on how to create a poster in Photoshop using text, shapes, and layer styles.

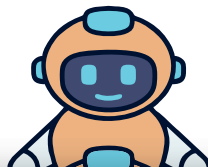
Lab Activity 1: Create a New File and Save It



Objective: Learn to set up and save a new project.

1. Create a new file with dimensions of 1024x768 pixels.
2. Add a background colour and text using the Text Tool.
3. Save the project as PSD and export as JPEG.

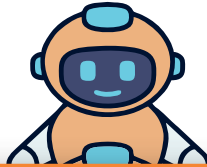
Lab Activity 2: Using Layers



Objective: Understand and practise layer management.

1. Create a poster with a background, text, and a decorative shape, each on separate layers.
2. Apply layer styles like Drop Shadow or Gradient Overlay.
3. Save the file with layers intact and as a flattened JPEG.

Lab Activity 3: Working with Selection Tools



Objective: Practise making selections and applying effects.

1. Open an image and use the Rectangular Marquee Tool to select an area.
2. Fill the selection with a solid colour or pattern.
3. Save the file with the changes.

Lab Activity 4: Designing with Text and Shapes



Objective: Create a simple design combining text and shapes.

1. Open a new file and add a background colour.
2. Use the Shape Tool to add geometric shapes and customize their fill and stroke.
3. Add text using the Text Tool and apply layer styles like shadows or gradients.
4. Save the design in PSD format and export it as PNG.